

"A caste count today is needed not only for backward and scheduled castes, but also for forward castes... The data is crucial for designing welfare schemes, identifying economic backwardness and addressing it effectively"

DR ANBUMANI RAMADOSS,
President, PMK, & Former Union Minister of Health

SKILL GAP



"In India, skilling is often an add-on to academia, not central to education or industry. It is stigmatised as blue-collar work... Integrating skills into all job levels and enhancing career paths can bridge this gap"

KANISHKA ARUMUGAM
Co-CEO, Ekki Water Technologies

REIMAGINING COIMBATORE AS INDIA'S NEW BUSINESS POWERHOUSE

"Coimbatore is well-positioned as a manufacturing hub with a low risk of natural calamities, surrounded by hills and well-connected to Tamil Nadu and Kerala, making it a prime candidate for industrial growth"

MITHUN RAMDAS
President, Southern India Engineering Manufacturers' Association



"Tiruppur, a textile hub complementing Coimbatore, generates Rs 75,000 crore in business, with Rs 45,000 crore from exports. We are hit by the US tariffs, but we are resilient"

N. THIRUKKUMARAN
Gen. Secy, Tiruppur Exporters' Association, and Chairman, Esstee Exports India Pvt. Ltd

"Coimbatore must urgently address labour shortages, improve roads and rail, and ensure affordable raw materials to become a future business hub. Tiruppur needs advancements in man-made fibre tech and automation in sewing operations"

JOSE CHARLES MARTIN
MD, Martin Group



HEALING 2.0: WHERE INNOVATION MEETS CARE

"Clean drinking water can save more children than all the hospital groups—Manipal, Apollo, Max—put together in the country; that is the beauty of preventive care... My mantra for a viable healthcare system is universal health insurance not necessarily coverage"

DR H. SUDARSHAN BALLAL
Chairman, Manipal Health Enterprises